

PROVINCE OF SURREY

Weybridge Lodge No. 6787

Information for Prospective Members

“Looking for something more than just a night out?”

A friendly, sociable group of men in Guildford, aged 18 to 80, who meet to build genuine friendships, support local charities, and grow as people.

A WARM WELCOME

Thank you for getting in touch with Weybridge Lodge No. 6787 to find out more about Freemasonry and about us. As Membership Officer, it's my pleasure to send you this short guide, which we hope answers your first questions. There's no obligation at this stage — simply a friendly introduction, and an open door if you'd like to take things further.

Weybridge Lodge was consecrated on 29th January 1949, founded by members of Noel Money Lodge together with workers from the Vickers Armstrong factory in Weybridge. We celebrated our 75th Anniversary in February 2024. Today our membership spans a wide range of ages, backgrounds and occupations, and we are proud of our reputation as one of the most open, friendly and welcoming Lodges in the Province of Surrey.

Freemasonry is one of the world's oldest and largest non-political, non-religious fraternal and charitable organisations. It teaches moral lessons through allegory and ceremony, using the tools and language of medieval stonemasons as symbols for self-improvement, integrity and care for others. Membership is open to men from all backgrounds and walks of life; the only religious requirement is a personal belief in a Supreme Being, however that is understood — there is no requirement to belong to, or practise, any particular faith.

WHAT HAPPENS AT A MEETING

A typical Lodge meeting has two parts. The first is the formal business of the Lodge — minutes, correspondence, accounts — conducted in our Lodge room (the “Temple”) and, on most meetings, one of the three degree ceremonies through which a candidate progresses: Initiation (First Degree), Passing (Second Degree) and Raising (Third Degree). The second part is the Festive Board — a good dinner, wine, toasts and cheerful company — which is where the real fellowship of the evening happens and where new members and visitors are made especially welcome.

MEETING VENUE & DATES

Venue	South West Surrey Masonic Centre, Hitherbury Close, Guildford, GU2 4DR — a 10-minute walk from Guildford railway station or the Friary bus station.
Regular meetings	The Lodge holds four Regular Meetings a year, usually tiling (starting) at 5.00–5.30pm, followed by a Festive Board from around 7.30pm. These include our Installation Meeting (October), when a new Worshipful Master and his Officers are installed, and our December Meeting, traditionally reserved for Initiating new members and celebrated with a festive-themed Festive Board.
Full calendar	See this Masonic year's specific meeting dates at weybridgelodge.org.uk/events .
Lodge of Instruction (LoI)	Every Thursday at 7.30pm (between September and May), at the South West Surrey Masonic Centre. This informal weekly rehearsal and mentoring session is where new members learn ritual and ceremony alongside experienced Brethren, and is open to Freemasons from any Lodge. It's also one of the best ways to get to know the Lodge socially before your first meeting.

WHO WE ARE

Founded	29th January 1949 — 75th Anniversary celebrated February 2024
Province	Provincial Grand Lodge of Surrey
Age range	Members currently range in age from 18 to 80
Character	Open, friendly and sociable — with a strong, well-supported Lodge of Instruction and an active social and charitable calendar (Charity Gala, golf day, clay pigeon shooting, Topgolf, and more)

COSTS OF MEMBERSHIP

Freemasonry does involve some cost, and we believe in being upfront about this from the outset — no one should join, or feel unable to join, without a clear picture of what to expect. Costs are kept as reasonable as we can manage, and no Brother is ever expected to spend beyond his means; charitable giving in particular is always entirely a matter of personal choice and circumstance. Current figures are:

- UGLE registration fee (one-off, payable on Initiation): £132
- Annual subscription: £250 — supports Lodge activities and charitable giving
- Festive Board (three-course dinner, after each meeting): approximately £32 — bar and raffle are entirely optional extras
- Under-21s: 50% reduction on both the registration fee and the annual subscription

Our Secretary will happily talk you through the exact current figures when you get in touch.

THE JOINING PROCESS

1. Get in touch — by email, phone, or the enquiry form at weybridgelodge.org.uk/contact. Tell us a little about yourself and what's prompted your interest.
2. Informal chat — our Secretary will contact you to answer questions and arrange an informal, no-obligation visit to the South West Surrey Masonic Centre, usually alongside a Lodge of Instruction evening so you can meet members socially.
3. Meet the Brethren — you'll be invited to a Festive Board or social event as a guest, to get a genuine feel for the Lodge before deciding anything.
4. Application & interview — if you'd like to proceed, you'll complete a formal application, which is followed by a friendly, informal interview with a small group of members.
5. Proposal and ballot — you are proposed and seconded by members of the Lodge, and balloted for at a Regular Meeting, in line with long-standing Masonic custom.
6. Initiation — once approved, you are initiated into the Lodge, formally becoming an Entered Apprentice Freemason and beginning your journey through the three degrees, typically over 12–18 months, supported at every step by a personal Mentor.

FURTHER READING

- Lodge website: weybridgelodge.org.uk — including our History, Officers, and Frequently Asked Questions pages
- weybridgelodge.org.uk/faq — answers to the questions we're asked most often
- United Grand Lodge of England: ugle.org.uk
- Provincial Grand Lodge of Surrey: surreymasons.org.uk
- Instagram, Facebook, X and TikTok: @weybridgelodge

GET IN TOUCH

We would love to hear from you. Please contact us at:

Secretary	secretary@weybridgelodge.org.uk
Events & meeting calendar	weybridgelodge.org.uk/events

We look forward to meeting you.